Minutes – April 30th, 2024

Chair: Josh Windle

Member Attendance:

Present: Beth Creighton, Josh Windle, Tarra Stumpf, Rebecca Williams, Karthik Shivkumar, Bethany Leis, Keiko App, Robert Real

Absent:

Regrets: Kawaljeet Kaur

1. Call to Order – Josh Windle

2. Territorial Acknowledgement

3. Approval of Minutes of previous meeting – Approved

4. Approval/Additions to the Agenda - Approved

5. Principal's Report – Beth Creighton

Family Engagement Night is being held on Thursday, May 23rd, from 5:30-7pm. Funds to support a Multicultural Arts Night - Staff are already planning a Family Engagement Night, with a focus on the Arts, for April/May - if Council would like to commit to volunteering to contribute to the enhancement of this night by providing ideas and organizing students and volunteers, this would be a great addition to what we already have planned. Funding would be needed for materials to support activities; Henna, food and refreshments, tokens of appreciation for guests, etc. Activities include:

- Art Gallery and Slideshow Presentation in the gym
- Gently Used Book Swap
- Music on the Tarmac
- Playground Games on the Field
- Complimentary Starbucks Coffee for adults
- Freezie Sales for the kids (and young at heart!)
- Unveiling of our new Butterfly Garden fencing co-created by the students at Country Hills

We would love to showcase and celebrate the diverse cultures that make Country Hills such a beautiful place to work and learn.

6. Educator Representative Reports - Aaron Fewkes

Updates:

- April 22-26: The school celebrated Earth Week with a variety of activities: announcements, yard clean-up, read alouds, classroom art projects, a collaborative art project (bulletin board outside the library), and a spirit assembly on the Friday of the week.
- Kodaly continuing to practice. Show at Centre in the Square on May 8th. Kodaly also performed two songs at the Earth Week spirit assembly.

- Running club continues, running 2x/week. Thanks to the leadership of Ms. Heather Nichols & Mrs. McLeman, about 50 children are participating.
- Intramurals continue for Junior students: this month it has been floorball. Thanks Mr. Gill!
- Playground structures are now back open, following the Winter season, giving children more choice of activities at nutrition break.
- Gearing up for a busy May/June: Spring emergency drills (ongoing), family engagement night (May 23), track and field (May 13, Rain date = May 14), spirit day in May (All About Me, May 30), spirit day in June (Red/White, June 27), continuing monthly assemblies, EQAO (June 4-7), Kindergarten welcome to school night (June 12), talent show (June 20, Rain date = June 21), year-end activities. These are tentative dates, confirmed dates to come in May report.

7. Treasurer's Report:

PRO-Grant funding in the amount of $750.00. To be used for Family Engagement Night as follows:

Print Materials - $200

Supplies to Support Family-Led Activities- $300

Refreshments - $75-$100

Incidentals - -$150

8. Sub-Committee Reports:

• WRAPSC Reports, Tarra Stumpf

An update was provided on the April 2nd, 2024 WRAPSC meeting. The primary presentation was from Steve McCrae, Principal of central education, support services, on Individual Education Plans (IEP), specifically on how students qualify and how students are supported. Detailed Minutes are in Appendix A as provided by Tarra. The Next Meeting of WRAPSC is scheduled for Tuesday, May 7th, 7:00 PM

9. Discussion Items:

10.Future Meeting Dates:

June 11th, 2024

Appendix A: Minutes From WRAPSC

AGENDA

MEETING OF THE WATERLOO REGION ASSEMBLY OF PUBLIC SCHOOL COUNCILS

TUESDAY, April 2nd, 2024 7:00 PM – 9:00 PM

Time Agenda Item Presenter/Facilitator

7:00 to 7:05 Welcome and Territorial Acknowledgment, Review of Agenda Sara/Jackie

7:05-8:00 <u>went to 830</u> Speaker IEP/Special Education – Steve McCrae (principal of central education, support services)

Individual Education Plans (IEP) supposed to be given within 30 days of school start. written action plan describing the spec ed program and supportive services required by a student) documents that support IEP creation, report cards, academic assessments, psych ed assessment, medical documentation, speech language assessment

Mental health, and 3 other pillars

Learning for all (2013)document , all students can succeed, all students have their own pattern of learning, unviseral designe and differential instruction, fairness is not sameness (whats needed in the moment)

Special edu in Ontario kinder-grade 12 document (IEP's policy and procedure manual)

How are kids supported: plan act, assess, reflect

- Classroom team (tier one supports) (teacher, edu assit , dece, inschool support team, multidisciplinary team)
- In school supports Tiere two (Cyw, principal spec ed teacher)
- Multidisciplinary support team tier three (principal, vice, spec ed, board level speech language pathologist, psychologist, social worker)

Extensive list of specialists available at the board level

Universal design for learning (accessible tasks for all students)

Differentation (knowing each student strengths and needs, learning tasks can be informed by assessment and tailored for groups and individuals)

Accommodations on an IEP (changes to instructional, environmental or assessment process- how content is presented, and the way they show they know).

How many kids have an IEP? He didn't answer

How does a student qualify for education assistant support? Thru the student support process model – a shared support model, the school, l aesources llocations are spread to the most good for all. Limited rresources

What is the role of student council in advocating for support? No role for council. It comes down to the student, assessment pieces and parent advocacy.

How do you get an IEP going access an IEP- start with the classroom teacher

EA's, coverage in schools and training for staff? EA valuable component of schools -staffing shortages , encourage conestoga college to do placement in schools and offer entry level positions to encourage they to join our board.

How often are occasional staff utilized? Didn't answer, said its an HR question.

Gifted education with is the process for identification in WRDSB? Gifted teachers, congregated settings gr 4-8. Assessment eval, reliance on school level.

How are IEP's evaluated? With the teacher and the principal

what is the process a parent should follow if they feel their child's IEP is overlooked or not being adhered to ? as in the resources and accommodations listed are not being realized start with the classroom tewcher and spec ed teacher

16-54% of kids have IEP – not enough resources. Paperwork is great, beautiful plan but no resources to execute the plan (a parent shared this) Amy Pharoah

8:25 PM
https://www.wrdsb.ca/learning/programs/special-education/
"More than 14,000 students receive some form of special education assistance each year."
Amy Pharoah
8:29 PM
https://www.app.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/sift/schoolProfile.asp?SCH_NUMBER=518905&x=24&y=19
each school shows spec ed percentages
https://www.app.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/sift/index.asp

how to address the lack of resources. Capaciety building and teacher learning support is the answer as per steve

What can parents do to free up resources. Lunch duity? Other ways to free up the teachers. There is liability of who can be in the school – education piece with the principles to be mor willing to allow volunteers Michelle Newlands (Superintendent)

8:00-8:15 830 start Best Practice Supporting Special Education Sara

School council should invite spec ed teacher to speak at meeting? 85% say no

Has admin spoke ot the council about navigating the system if your student has special needs 75% no

Do you know what the Special education advisory committee (SEAC) is at your school? 90% no

Does your school have an active safe caring inclusive school (SCIS) group 50%no WE DO! Its mandatory.

Is there a parent on the school scis team ? NO a parent is supposed to be on the group

What is the end of your celebration. This is the message to the principles on what to do. The principle knows whats best for their school, the school gets to decide what the celebration is . it should be equitable, across all schools. Some councils have lots ave nneyeingcan have a big party, some councils have notheing

Picnic

Eparty

Fun fair

Bbq

Spirit wear sales

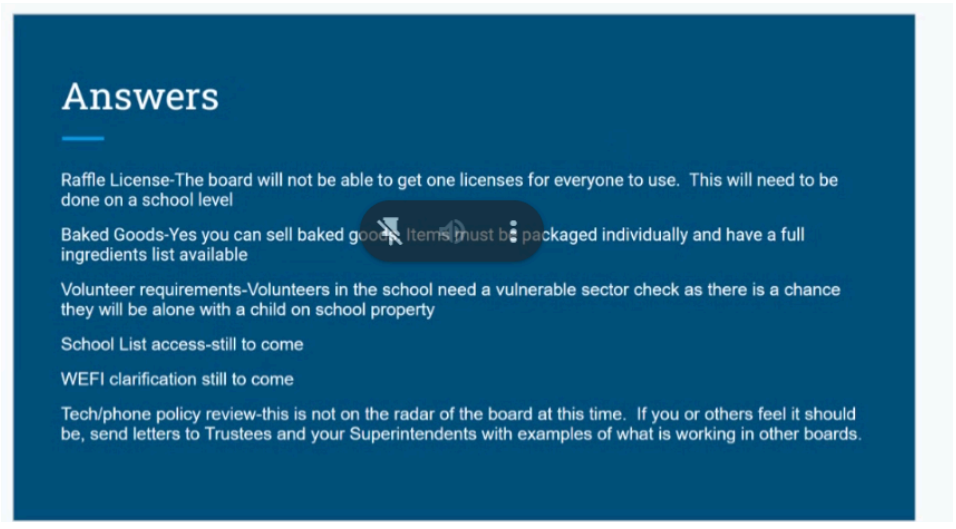
8:15-8:30 PIC Jackie

Unable to hear her update

Looking for sub committed members ??? scic, communication, environmental , recruitment, prograant. maybe email Jackie if interested?

PIC application for new members coming soon

8:30-8:55 Large Group Question Period Sara



School list access – fundraising lists, to deliver the product. Yes we can have access with some restrictions according to superintendent michelle.

8:50-8:55 Closing: Future meeting dates

Next meeting: Tues. May 7, 7-9 pm Sara